



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Let's plan an event!



Learning Outcome:

Describe routines and regular activities in a wide range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements:

- I can pronounce weak forms in questions.
- I can respond politely to suggestions and offers.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- What kind of events are usually hosted by your company?
- What things do you need to keep in mind when planning one?





Let's Explore!

Miranda, Ferdinand and Rocco discuss the logistics of the event. What do they decide to do?



Instructions: Read the dialogue aloud.

- Ferdinand:** Does this meeting concern logistics?
- Miranda:** Yes and no. Why don't we start with a date and a venue?
- Ferdinand:** That's a good start. Do you have a date in mind?
- Miranda:** I regret to inform that we don't. When does Sao Paulo fashion week begin?
- Ferdinand:** Four Fridays from today.
- Rocco:** I'm afraid that's too soon. Do you remember Anthropology's scheduled PR event?
- Miranda:** That was a commercial disaster. I'm confident our forthcoming event will be more organized. So we have a date. Should we decide upon a time?
- Ferdinand:** Certainly. There's a one hour difference between Sao Paulo and Boston. If we want to direct attention to our product, we would start at 7 p.m. here and 6 p.m. in Boston. What do you say?
- Miranda:** It's definitely a great idea.
- Ferdinand:** There's also a slot at 9 p.m.
- Miranda:** No, thanks. 6 p.m. is great. Ferdinand, do you have enough clout to argue for a celebrity hosting our show?
- Ferdinand:** Not sure, but I'll do my best.
- Miranda:** Now a venue. What's a good location for a band, fashion show and reception?
- Ferdinand:** How about the train station hall? There's plenty of space there.
- Miranda:** Perfect. I'll look into the venue this afternoon.



Let's Practice!

When do you want the event to take place?

Instructions: Read the interrogative sentences aloud. Underline all the weak forms in the questions. Check your pronunciation with your teacher.

1. Does anyone want some coffee?
2. Does this meeting concern logistics?
3. Do we have a date in mind?
4. When does fashion week begin?
5. What do you say?



Let's Practice!

I'm sure she's got enough clout to argue for a celebrity.

Instructions: Read the conversation and write the missing words in the corresponding place. Use capital letters where necessary. Role play the conversation aloud with a partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. **Miranda:** Do you want some coffee?
Ferdinand: I'm _____, thanks.
2. **Miranda:** Why don't we start with a date and a venue?
Ferdinand: That _____.
3. **Ferdinand:** What do you say about starting the events simultaneously?
Miranda: _____.
4. **Ferdinand:** Do we have a date in mind?
Miranda: _____ we don't.
5. **Miranda:** The event is in four Fridays from now. Can we do it?
Ferdinand: I' _____.

Words

- I regret to inform that
- 'm afraid that's too soon.
- is a good start.
- OK for now
- It's definitely a great idea.



Extension Activity

Let's plan a work event!

*Instructions: Complete the following steps.
Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- You are going to plan an event at your workplace.
- Go online and do some research on how to plan an event and what to include.
- Discuss your event plans with a partner.
- Your partner will ask questions about the date, the music, the time, etc.
- Respond politely to all questions.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I research information on event planning.

☐ ☐

I share my event ideas with a partner.

☐ ☐

I respond to questions politely.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **commercial disaster** (expression)
an event or product that was a failure
e.g. That PR event was a commercial disaster
- **forthcoming** (adjective)
happening or coming soon
e.g. I'm confident our forthcoming event will be more organized.
- **to direct attention to** (expression)
to focus your concern on someone or something
e.g. We should direct attention to our product.
- **clout** (noun)
the authority to make decisions or the power to influence events
e.g. Do you have enough clout to argue for a celebrity hosting our show?
- **logistics** (noun)
the arrangements necessary in order to organize something successfully, especially something involving a lot of people
e.g. Is this a meeting regarding logistics?



Learning Points

Responding Politely to Questions

It is normal to be asked questions from friends, coworkers, and family. When responding to these questions, it is important to be polite. Here are some phrases to politely respond to questions.

Saying "Yes" Politely	Saying "No" Politely
• <i>Yes, that's a good start / idea.</i> • <i>Certainly.</i> • <i>It's definitely a good / great idea.</i> • <i>Perfect</i>	• <i>I'm OK for now.</i> • <i>I regret to inform that + clause</i> • <i>I'm afraid + clause</i> • <i>No, thanks.</i> • <i>Not sure, but ... + clause</i>

Examples

- *A: Hey, do you want some tea?*
- *B: **No, thanks. I'm OK for now.***
- *A: Do you have a time in mind?*
- *B: **I'm afraid** not. How about next week?*
- *A: **Perfect.***
- *A: Let's have the event next week.*
- *B: **Certainly.***
- *A: Why don't we start by choosing a venue?*
- *B: **That's a good start.***

Weak Form in Questions

English is different from many languages because it is a stress-time language. This means that some words are stressed and others are not when speaking.

Content words (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs) are usually stressed. However, grammar words (auxiliary verbs, pronouns, conjunctions, prepositions, etc) are not. Because they have no stress, they are weakened when we speak.

Content words are stressed and pronounced in their full form - "strong form" as opposed to grammar words that are pronounced in their "weak form".

Weak forms are common in questions with auxiliary verbs. They are sometimes a bit difficult to hear properly.

Examples

- *Does anyone want something to drink? ("does" is almost not pronounced while "anyone" is stronger)*
- *Do you remember when the event is? ("Do" and "you" are both weak and sound like "dya")*
- *Do you have time to talk about the event?*
- *When does the event begin?*

